

L2 Peer-to-Peer Learning Sessions

Pillar	Learning	Difficulty	Level 1
Time Required	45-60 minutes (per session)	Group Size	4-10
Mode	Team facilitation	Format	In-person or remote
Prerequisites	L1 (Skills Diagnostic) recommended to identify topics and teachers	CLOVER ERA Trigger	Lack of cross-team learning, uneven skill development, low engagement in formal learning programs, no culture of continuous learning

Why This Works

THE NEUROSCIENCE

Social learning activates the brain's mirror neuron system. When we learn from a peer rather than a textbook or video, the brain engages empathy circuits alongside learning circuits. The result is deeper encoding: information learned from someone we know and trust is retained more effectively than information from an anonymous source.

Teaching is also one of the most powerful learning mechanisms for the teacher. The act of organising knowledge for presentation forces the brain to restructure and deepen its own understanding (the "protege effect"). Peer learning creates a double benefit: the learner gains knowledge and the teacher consolidates expertise.

The dopamine system also responds differently to peer learning. Learning from a colleague who faced the same challenges provides a progress signal: 'If they can do it, so can I.' This is more motivating than learning from an expert whose competence feels unreachable.

The Exercise

Phase 1: Topic and Teacher Matching (first session only, 10 minutes)

Using the team gap map from L1, identify the first 2-3 peer learning sessions:

- Match a skill gap with a team member who has expertise in that area
- Confirm the teacher is willing and comfortable (do not volunteer people without asking)
- Schedule sessions at a regular cadence (biweekly works well; weekly is too frequent for most teams)

FACILITATION NOTE

The teacher does not need to be an expert. They need to know more than the learners and be willing to share what they know. Framing matters: "You're the most experienced person on this team in [skill]. Would you be willing to run a 30-minute session sharing what you've learned?" is more effective than "Can you teach a class?"

Phase 2: Session Structure (ongoing sessions, 45 minutes)

Each peer learning session follows a consistent structure:

Time	Phase	What Happens
0-5 min	Context	Teacher explains why this skill matters and where it shows up in the team's work. Connects to real examples.
5-20 min	Core Teaching	Teacher shares their approach, demonstrates techniques, walks through a real example. Not a lecture. Conversational, with questions encouraged throughout.
20-35 min	Practice	Learners try applying the skill to a real or realistic scenario. Teacher coaches in real time. This is where the actual learning happens.
35-45 min	Debrief	What clicked? What's still unclear? What will you try this week? Each person names one specific application.

WHAT TO SAY (MANAGER, AT THE START OF EACH SESSION)

"This is not a formal training. This is [Name] sharing what they know because they've been doing it well and the rest of us can learn from them. Interrupt, ask questions, disagree. The best learning happens in the conversation, not the presentation."

Phase 3: Follow-Up Application

Between sessions, each learner applies one thing from the session to their actual work. At the start of the next session, 5 minutes for quick check-ins: "What did you try? What worked? What didn't?" This creates a learning-practice-feedback loop that dramatically improves retention.

Facilitation Notes

Situation	Response
The teacher over-prepares and delivers a lecture	Coach beforehand: "The goal is 50% teaching, 50% practice. If you find yourself talking for more than 15 minutes straight, pause and give people something to try." Most internal teachers default to lecture mode because that's what they've experienced in formal training.

Attendance drops after the first 2-3 sessions	This usually means sessions aren't relevant enough or the application phase isn't happening. Ask: "Are these topics still your priority gaps?" and "Are you finding opportunities to use what you're learning?" Adjust topics based on current team needs.
Nobody wants to be the teacher	This is a vulnerability issue. Teaching exposes you to questions you might not be able to answer. Normalise it: "You don't need to know everything. You just need to know more than the rest of us about this topic. And it's completely fine to say 'I don't know, let me find out.'"

Signs This Is Working

Timeframe	What to Look For
During sessions	Learners ask questions and challenge the teacher's approach The practice phase produces visible learning ("Oh, I see how that works now") Sessions feel like conversations, not presentations
Between sessions	Learners apply what they learned and report back The teacher's own understanding deepens from preparing and responding to questions Team members reference skills learned in peer sessions during regular work
CLOVER ERA data (4-8 weeks)	Learning scores increase Cross-team learning signals improve Qualitative data references colleagues teaching, sharing, or developing together

Cross-Pillar Connections

Worksheet	Connection	Direction
L1: Skills Diagnostic	L1 identifies the topics and teachers. L2 activates them.	Run L1 before L2
L7: Real-World Application	L7 ensures peer learning translates to work. The follow-up application phase in L2 is a lightweight version of L7.	Complementary
V2: Failure Stories	Teaching requires vulnerability. V2's normalisation of failure makes it safer to teach (and to not know all the answers).	V2 supports L2